Literature Review ↗

Egyptian Dates Export Analytics & Dashboards

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01

Summary

“

This review looks at what has already been studied, built and measured about Egyptian dates exports, so DateSight starts from evidence instead of starting from zero. The literature agrees on the core problem: Egypt leads the world in production but holds a small share of exports. Most studies measure this with competitiveness indices published in papers, not with interactive dashboards. The sources also show weak data on date varieties and export figures that differ from one source to another. These findings shape how we collect, validate, analyse and forecast the data in the next phases.

15	6	6
sources reviewed	studies on Egyptian dates exports	gaps turned into project decisions

The 15 sources are 6 studies on Egyptian dates, 2 trade-data platforms, 3 industry and news sources, 1 sector overview and 3 papers on forecasting short series (full list in the References section).

02

Review Objectives

01

Understand what is already known about Egypt’s dates exports, markets and competitiveness.

02

Identify the data sources, tools and methods used in similar work.

03

Find the gaps that DateSight can fill.

04

Turn the findings into clear decisions for our data collection, modeling, analysis and dashboards.

> **How this review connects to the plan**
> Each finding in this document is linked to a phase of the DateSight plan: Data Collection, Data Modeling, Data Cleaning, Data Analysis, Visualization, and Testing, Docs and Final.

03

Scope and Method

→ Inclusion

- Studies and reports on Egyptian dates exports, competitiveness and markets.
- Trade-data platforms that cover dates (HS 0804).
- Industry and news sources on varieties, export figures and national strategy.
- Papers on forecasting short annual series.

→ Exclusion

- Studies about date palm farming techniques only, with no trade or market content.
- Company price lists and sales material.

→ Method

- We searched Egyptian agricultural-economics journals, trade platforms and industry news in October 2026.
- Each source was compared on three points: the data it uses, the method it applies and what it found.
- Limitation: several Arabic journal articles were reviewed through their published abstracts and summaries, so their details should be re-checked in the full text before final submission.

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Egypt’s Dates Sector in Brief

Topic	What the sources say	Source
Production	Egypt is the largest date producer, with about 18% of world production in 2021 and about 1.65 million tonnes. [2] [9]	[2] [9]
Export share	Egypt’s share of world exports is small, but the figure changes by source: below 3% [2], about 3% [5], about 2.1% [3], below 4% in 2020 [11], and 4.5% in 2023 (8th exporter) [9].	[2] [3] [5] [9] [11]
Export value	About USD 43 million in 2020 [11]; USD 88.15 million in 2023 [9]; about USD 90 million a year, around 1% of agricultural exports [10].	[9] [10] [11]
Markets	63 importing countries in 2020 [11] and 71 markets in 2023 [9]. Morocco, Indonesia, Turkey and Russia are named as leading importers [10]; Morocco, Indonesia, Malaysia and Bangladesh are the markets studied in [1] and [2].	[1] [2] [9] [10] [11]
Varieties	In 2020 an official said only Siwi and Saidi were exported, and that Zaghloul and Samani were not exportable [11]. A later article says the current focus is premium types such as Medjool, Sukkary, Khalas and Ajwa, and that semi-dry types are only about 20% of production [10]. Medjool and Barhi are described as rare in Egypt [5]. An older sector overview groups Egyptian cultivars into fresh types such as Hayani, Zagloul and Samani, and half-dry types [15].	[5] [10] [11] [15]
Strategy	A national strategy for the date palm sector was set for 2024–2029 [9]. One article reports a target of USD 250 million export revenue within five years [10].	[9] [10]

Takeaway for DateSight

The same indicator, Egypt’s share of world dates exports, ranges from about 2% to 4.5% across sources. DateSight must record the source, year and definition of every figure and reconcile them with Trade Map data before using them in dashboards.

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Related Studies

Study	Method	Main findings	What DateSight takes
[1] Arab Universities J. Agric. Sci. (2016)	Competitiveness indicators and econometric analysis of Egyptian dates exports.	Egypt has an advantage in market penetration in Morocco, Indonesia, Malaysia and Lebanon. The geographic concentration coefficient is close to zero, which the authors flag as a problem. Competitors had a price advantage.	Add market-share, concentration (HHI) and price comparison views.
[2] Assem et al. (2023)	Market share, market penetration rate and revealed comparative advantage (RCA), with scenarios to 2034 for four main markets.	Egypt has a significant comparative advantage. In a business-as-usual scenario its expected share of world imports drifts down, from about 2.4% in 2022 to about 1.6% in 2034.	Present forecasts as scenarios with ranges, not one number.
[3] Menoufia J. study (article 416789)	Assesses competitiveness and export efficiency, and the future of production and exports.	Egypt's exports are only about 2.1% of global exports despite its top production position.	Frame the analysis around the production-to-export gap.
[4] Egypt vs Tunisia (2021)	Balassa RCA index on fresh and dry dates markets.	Compares the two countries to propose ways of improving Egypt's marketing position in export markets.	Benchmark Egypt against a competitor; split by product type if data allow.
[5] New Valley case study	Competitiveness measures, geographic distribution of exports and export efficiency.	Egypt's share of world exports is about 3%. Medjool and Barhi are noted as rare varieties in Egypt.	Use as context for the varieties limitation.
[6] Abd El-Kawy et al. (2025)	Trends in the quantity, value and price of world dates exports, and Egypt's competitive position.	Places Egypt inside the world trend and lists problems facing date palm production.	Include a world-trend and price-per-tonne view.

Findings are taken from the abstracts and summaries of each study; see the Scope and Method section.

06

Existing Tools and Platforms

Tool	What it offers	Limits for our project	How we use it
ITC Trade Map [7]	Yearly trade flows for over 220 countries and territories and 5,300 products at 2, 4 and 6-digit HS level. Indicators include market share, market concentration and unit values. Time series since 2001, shown as tables, graphs and maps.	Some features need an account or a paid subscription. It covers all products, so it gives no date-specific analysis, and it does not separate varieties.	Main source for country-level exports and quantities, 2016–2025. Download early.
OEC [8]	Country and bilateral profiles with top products, trade value, annualized growth and economic complexity ranking.	General purpose. Egypt profiles group fruit into broad categories such as “Other Fruits”, so dates are not isolated.	Cross-check totals and use for context only.
Industry and news sources [9] [10] [11]	Factsheets and articles with export values, markets, varieties and strategy.	Secondary sources. Figures differ between sources and years (see section 04).	Use to explain events and context, and label as secondary.

Takeaway for DateSight
General trade platforms give the raw numbers but not a ready view for dates. DateSight adds a focused, interactive dashboard on HS 080410 built on validated data.

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Methods Used in Similar Work

→ Measuring competitiveness

- Revealed comparative advantage (Balassa index) [4] and market penetration rate [1] [2].
- Market share of importing markets [1] [2] and geographic concentration [1].
- Price competitiveness against competing exporters [1] [5].
- These match the analysis planned for phase 4 of DateSight: YoY growth, CAGR, share of HS 0804, concentration (HHI), competitor benchmarking and price per tonne.

→ Forecasting short series

- Simple and Holt exponential smoothing performed well on small samples, especially for short-term forecasts [12].
- On short and unstable data with structural breaks, exponential smoothing was slightly worse at short horizons and better at longer ones; neural networks fit the past well but predicted poorly [13].
- On a longer quarterly series (1998–2017), ARIMA beat exponential smoothing and VAR, with the authors advising caution [14].

Takeaway for DateSight
With about 10 annual points (2016–2025), we prefer simple trend and smoothing models, avoid complex ones, back-test on held-out years and show scenario ranges. This supports our KPI of a back-test error of 20% or less.

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Gap Analysis

Gap	Evidence	How DateSight responds
Static, general analysis	Reviewed studies publish indices in journal articles [1] [2] [3] [4] [5] [6]. Platforms give broad product data [7] [8].	Interactive Tableau dashboard (4–5 pages) with filters, KPIs and annotations, focused on HS 080410.
Thin data on varieties	An official named only two exported varieties in 2020 [11]; a later article names other premium types [10]. Our Excel file reports dates as one code.	Treat the varieties comparison as conditional; document the limitation (Risk R1).
Figures differ between sources	Export share ranges from about 2% to 4.5% (section 04).	Data Sources Register, validation checks, and a cited source for every dashboard figure.
Country-level data is hard to get	Trade Map has restricted and paid features [7].	Download early; fall back to world-level analysis plus competitors (Risk R2).
Sharp year-to-year swings need explanation	Our file shows −19% in 2017, +50% in 2018 and +35% in 2022, while the abstracts reviewed mostly report period-level indicators.	Insight log: every explanation needs a cited source, otherwise it is labeled a hypothesis (Risk R3).
Short series for forecasting	About 10 annual points [12] [13] [14].	Scenario ranges and back-tests on held-out years (Risk R4).

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Suggested Improvements

01
Add the definition and year basis of each figure to the Data Sources Register.

02
Use Trade Map as the main country-level source and download it in the first week.

03
Add a price-per-tonne and competitor price comparison page, since price competitiveness appears in the studies.

04
Show forecasts as ranges with a back-test, not a single line.

05
Keep varieties as optional work unless reliable data is found.

→ Future work

- Variety-level analysis if reliable data appear.
- Add a revealed comparative advantage (RCA) view once country and quantity data are available.

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Lecturer Feedback and Evaluation

To be completed by the lecturer.

Feedback and evaluation

Suggested improvements from the lecturer

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